IELTS ACADEMIC · WRITING TASK 2

Writing a PEEL Body Paragraph

How to turn a point into a paragraph an examiner can follow

LEVEL Band 6.0 to 7.0 TIME 60 min FOCUS Task Response, Coherence and Cohesion

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. write a first sentence that makes one clear, arguable claim;
2. develop that claim with reasoning and a specific example;
3. finish with a link that answers the question, not a summary that repeats it.

The four moves

TAG	MOVE	WHAT IT DOES
P	Point	States one claim that directly answers the question.
Ex	Explain	Shows *why* or *how* the claim is true: the reasoning.
Eg	Example	Makes the reasoning concrete: a case, a scenario, a consequence.
L	Link	Shows how the paragraph answers the question as it is worded.

KEY POINT **Explain before you exemplify**

Many Band 6 paragraphs jump from the point straight to an example, so the reader has to guess why the example matters. The Explain sentence is where your reasoning becomes visible, and it is usually the move that lifts a paragraph into the Band 7 range.

One question, two paragraphs

In many cities, public libraries are being replaced by online information services. Do the advantages of this development outweigh the disadvantages?

✓ Effective · Band 7 range

[P] The strongest argument against closing libraries is that they offer free, supervised space, which no website can provide. [Ex] For students in crowded homes, a quiet, heated room with reliable internet is often the difference between studying and not studying at all. [Eg] A teenager revising for exams in a flat shared with four relatives, for instance, may find the local library is the only place where sustained concentration is possible. [L] The loss of physical libraries would therefore hit the least advantaged hardest, and this outweighs the convenience of online services.

✗ Less effective · Band 5 to 6

Libraries are very important for people. Many people use libraries every day. For example, my friend goes to the library at the weekend. Also, libraries have many books and computers and they are free. In conclusion, libraries should not be replaced by the internet.

Why the second version scores lower

- The first sentence is a truism: nobody would disagree, so there is nothing to argue.

不言自明的道理

- There is no Explain move. The example about a friend is personal and proves nothing about cities.
- "In conclusion" closes the essay, not a paragraph, and the last sentence never mentions advantages or disadvantages.

Chunks for the Explain and Link moves

CHUNK	PATTERN AND EXAMPLE
this is largely because	claim, then *this is largely because* + clause *Rents have risen sharply. This is largely because new housing has not kept pace with demand.*
which means that	adds a consequence to the previous clause *Online courses can be paused, which means that working adults can study at their own pace.*
a case in point is	introduces one specific example *A case in point is the bus lane scheme, which cut journey times within a year.*
hit someone disproportionately hard /ˌdɪs.prəˈpɔː.ʃən.ət.li/	verb + adverb; who suffers most *Price rises hit low-income families disproportionately hard.*
outweigh the benefits of	subject + *outweigh* + noun phrase; links back to the question *These costs clearly outweigh the benefits of a shorter school week.*

Self-test

1 Which sentence works best as the Point for this question: *Should governments tax sugary drinks?*

A Sugary drinks are popular all over the world.

B A tax on sugary drinks would cut consumption in the group most at risk: children.

C Many people have different opinions about taxes.

D Sugar is bad for your health and your teeth.

2 Write an Explain sentence for this point: *Remote work benefits employers as well as employees.*

CHECK YOUR OWN PARAGRAPH

- ☐ My first sentence makes one claim that answers the question.
- ☐ My Explain sentence says why or how, rather than adding another fact.
- ☐ My example is specific: a person, a place, a scenario or a consequence.
- ☐ My last sentence uses the key words of the question.